MR. LIFE MANAGER · WORKSHEET

The Household Agreement

Write down what you agree, and what still needs an answer.

> **WHY WRITING IT DOWN WORKS**
>
> An unwritten expectation gets renegotiated every single time. A written one was decided once. That's the entire trick — you're not being bureaucratic, you're closing a… decision so it stops costing you.

01 Who lives here

NAME

NAME

NAME

DATE AGREED

02 Who owns what

Not "we'll both do the kitchen." One name per line. **Owning a job means noticing it needs doing**, doing it, and knowing when supplies run out — not just the visible part.

JOB	OWNER	HOW OFTEN
Dishes		
Kitchen counters & stove		
Trash & recycling out		
Bathroom		
Floors — vacuum & mop		
Shared-space cleanup		
Buying shared supplies		
Fridge clear-out		
Dealing with the landlord		

FILLED EXAMPLE

Dishes	Sam — same night, before bed
Trash & recycling	Alex — out Tuesday, and buys the bags
Bathroom	Alternate weeks — Sam odd, Alex even

03 The invisible work

This is the part that gets skipped, and it's the part people actually resent. Someone is already doing all of it. Name them.

THE JOB NOBODY COUNTS	OWNER
Noticing we're out of something	
Actually paying the bills on time	
Scheduling repairs, chasing the landlord	
Knowing what's in the fridge	
Remembering when rent is due	
Being the one who says something when it slips	

> **WHY THIS SECTION EXISTS**
>
> Noticing is work. Tracking is work. Being the person who has to bring it up is *especially* work. If one person is doing all of it, they're carrying a second job nobody has... acknowledged — and that's what turns into a fight about dishes that isn't really about

04 What "clean enough" means

People have wildly different defaults and assume theirs is normal. Agree on the floor, not the ideal.

KITCHEN AT THE END OF A NIGHT SHOULD LOOK LIKE...

SHARED SPACES ON A NORMAL WEEKDAY SHOULD LOOK LIKE...

THINGS WE'VE AGREED WE GENUINELY DON'T CARE ABOUT

YOUR OWN ROOM: ANYTHING GOES, OR ARE THERE LIMITS?

05 Money

The two things that cause trouble: who *actually* pays the company, and what counts as shared.

BILL	IN WHOSE NAME	SPLIT HOW	DUE
Rent			
Electric			
Gas			
Internet			
Water / trash			

SHARED SUPPLIES WE SPLIT

HOW WE SETTLE UP, AND WHEN

> **THE ONE THAT BITES**
>
> Check the actual account and payment terms together. Record who pays the company, each person's share and transfer date, and how payment is confirmed. If you choose... autopay, agree how the account stays funded and charges are reviewed. Do not

06 Living together

GUESTS — HOW MUCH NOTICE, HOW OFTEN, HOW LONG

PARTNERS STAYING OVER — WHAT'S NORMAL, WHAT'S TOO MUCH

QUIET HOURS

FOOD — SHARED, SEPARATE, OR BOTH? WHAT'S OFF-LIMITS?

BORROWING EACH OTHER'S THINGS

ANYTHING ELSE THAT WOULD BOTHER YOU IF IT HAPPENED

07 When it slips — the script

It will slip. Agreeing *now* how you'll raise it means nobody has to invent a way to do it while annoyed.

> **WITHIN A FEW DAYS**
> Say it early, while it's still small and boring. A week of silence turns a dish into a character judgment.

> **NAME THE THING, NOT THE PERSON**
> *"The kitchen's been piling up this week"* — not *"you never do the dishes."*

> **ASK BEFORE YOU ASSUME**
> *"Is something going on, or did it just get away from you?"* Listen to the answer before proposing a change.

> **FIX THE SYSTEM, NOT JUST THE INSTANCE**
> If the same thing keeps slipping, the agreement is wrong. Change the agreement.

> **ASSUME GOOD FAITH**
> Ask about constraints and different expectations. Do not assume agreement or assign intent to the other person.

HOW WE'VE AGREED TO BRING THINGS UP

08 Open questions and check-in

An agreement nobody revisits becomes an agreement nobody honors. Put a real date on it.

UNRESOLVED QUESTION / INFORMATION NEEDED / OWNER / NEXT DISCUSSION:

_____

WE'LL REVIEW THIS ON

QUICK WEEKLY CHECK-IN — WHEN?

CHOOSE A REVIEW TIME TOGETHER

Ask what is coming up and what is not working. Allow enough time for unresolved questions; scheduling a review does not prove the agreement is working.

Record what everyone accepted

Sign only the agreements everyone affected accepts. Leave unresolved topics unsigned, with the question, who will get the missing information, and the next discussion date. This worksheet does not determine anyone's legal rights.

SIGNED

SIGNED

SIGNED

DATE

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